MSSE Capstone Project

Capstone Kickoff Meeting Minutes

TrustAI Marketplace

Date	July 1, 2026
Time	7:00 PM CAT
Location	Virtual team meeting
Meeting Type	Project kickoff, topic selection, Agile role assignment and initial planning
Prepared For	TrustAI Marketplace MSSE Capstone team records

1. Attendance and Roles

All six members of the MSSE Capstone team attended and participated in the kickoff discussion: Ahmed Al-Mandalawi, Ranga Nyamadzawo, Mulima Chibuye, Adrian Muchatibaya, Samar El Ghandour and Abdallah Mohmoud.

Name	Attendance	Role / status established at kickoff
Ahmed Al-Mandalawi	Present	Selected as Product Owner. Responsible for product vision, personas, user stories, initial backlog, acceptance criteria and functional direction.
Mulima Chibuye	Present	Selected as Scrum Master. Responsible for sprint cadence, project board, timeline, blockers and team coordination.
Ranga Nyamadzawo	Present	Development Team. Detailed technical workstream ownership was to be refined during backlog refinement and Sprint 1 planning.
Adrian Muchatibaya	Present	Development Team. Detailed technical workstream ownership was to be refined during backlog refinement and Sprint 1 planning.
Samar El Ghandour	Present	Development Team. Detailed technical workstream ownership was to be refined during backlog refinement and Sprint 1 planning.
Abdallah Mohmoud	Present	Development Team. Detailed technical workstream ownership was to be refined during backlog refinement and Sprint 1 planning.

2. Meeting Objective

The kickoff meeting moved the group from informal idea sharing into an agreed project direction. The immediate objectives were to select one Capstone topic, establish the required Agile leadership roles, agree on the initial delivery approach and identify the work that had to be completed before Sprint 1 could begin.

- Review the proposed Capstone ideas against feasibility, technical depth, available time and the MSSE Capstone expectations.
- Select one project concept for the team to develop.
- Assign the Product Owner and Scrum Master roles.
- Discuss repository collaboration, task-board options, sprint planning, user stories and backlog refinement.
- Agree on immediate follow-up actions and the purpose of the next meeting.

3. Project Ideas Discussed

The discussion centered on four principal ideas. The team consistently weighed technical interest against the practical need to deliver a working, well-engineered project within the remaining approximately two-and-a-half-month Capstone window.

3.1 AI-Assisted Online Proctoring - presented by Mulima Chibuye

Mulima Chibuye proposed an AI-assisted online proctoring platform for remote examinations. The concept would monitor exam sessions and identify potentially suspicious events such as a student leaving the camera view, another person appearing nearby, microphone or camera issues, screen switching and other possible examination-rule violations.

The team recognized the relevance of the problem, particularly as remote learning and online examinations continue to rely on camera, microphone and browser controls. The principal concern was delivery risk. A credible implementation could require substantial work in computer vision, audio monitoring, browser or desktop behavior, privacy safeguards, inference speed and decisions about local versus cloud processing. The idea was considered strong, but potentially too large for the available schedule.

3.2 AgriScout / Crop Disease Diagnosis - presented by Ranga Nyamadzawo

Ranga Nyamadzawo presented AgriScout, a mobile-first or web-based concept in which a farmer could photograph a crop or plant leaf and receive an AI-supported indication of possible disease together with treatment guidance.

The discussion considered the potential value for small-scale farmers who may not have easy access to agricultural specialists, laboratories or reliable treatment information. Computer vision, image processing, pattern recognition, AI agents, hosted models and a possible retrieval-augmented knowledge base were discussed as technical directions. Possible future extensions included expert labeling and improved treatment validation.

The main concerns were data quality, novelty and implementation effort. The team noted that similar applications may already exist and that creating a dependable agricultural knowledge base or image-classification workflow could become a significant undertaking. The concept remained viable, but would require strict scope control.

3.3 TrustAI Marketplace - presented by Ahmed Al-Mandalawi

Ahmed Al-Mandalawi presented TrustAI Marketplace as an AI-assisted decision-support application for online marketplace buyers. The concept was for a user to provide a marketplace listing, product description or URL and receive a structured assessment intended to help judge whether the listing appeared safe, fairly priced or suspicious.

The possible outputs discussed at kickoff included estimated market value, pricing comparison, scam indicators, a seller/listing risk score, a plain-English recommendation and practical questions a buyer could ask before completing a purchase. Ahmed explained that the problem is broadly applicable across markets because buyers in different countries face similar risks involving scams, counterfeit products, unrealistic pricing and missing or misleading information.

When the team asked how the AI component could work, Ahmed explained that the initial MVP could focus on listing text, URLs and user-provided details. More advanced inputs, including images, could be considered later if the schedule allowed. The group also examined whether enough work remained for the full team if some deployment groundwork already existed. Ahmed identified substantial remaining work across authentication, user management, listing processing, AI analysis, pricing and risk logic, database design, frontend development, testing, documentation, CI/CD and sprint delivery.

The team considered TrustAI Marketplace understandable, feasible within the available period and broad enough to demonstrate the software-engineering practices expected in the Capstone.

3.4 Real Estate AI Platform - presented by Adrian Muchatibaya

Adrian Muchatibaya summarized a real-estate decision-support platform involving property valuation, risk rating, investment guidance and location intelligence. The system could potentially help users evaluate homes, neighborhoods, affordability, investment potential and related risks.

The team agreed that the idea had value and could support substantial future development, but the likely need for several datasets, prediction models, location data and multiple major modules raised concerns about scope. Within the Capstone timeline, the concept appeared difficult to reduce to a polished MVP without sacrificing important functionality.

4. Project Selection and Decision

After discussing the four ideas, the team used a poll to select the project to take forward. TrustAI Marketplace received the strongest support and was selected as the Capstone project.

The decision reflected a balance of feasibility and technical depth. TrustAI Marketplace could be delivered as a working web application, divided into meaningful engineering workstreams and demonstrated clearly at the end of the program. The team also saw it as a vehicle for showing broader MSSE engineering practice rather than presenting only an isolated AI feature.

Decision

TrustAI Marketplace was selected as the team Capstone project and became the basis for the product vision, user stories, backlog refinement, sprint planning, architecture and implementation.

5. Strategic Context and Capstone Fit

A recurring theme was that the Capstone should demonstrate the team's learning across the MSSE program. The project therefore needed to show more than an interesting business idea: it needed to provide evidence of disciplined software engineering.

At kickoff, the team identified APIs, authentication, database design, frontend development, AI integration, automated testing, CI/CD, deployment, Agile planning, documentation and a working live system as areas that TrustAI Marketplace could bring together. A service-oriented or microservices-style direction was discussed as an early architectural approach to support parallel work. This was an initial planning direction, not a finalized architecture decision.

The team also emphasized early deployment. The intended outcome was a publicly accessible environment that could be improved across successive sprints, reducing the risk of discovering hosting or integration problems only near the submission deadline. The exact hosting platform and subdomain were left open for later confirmation.

6. Governance and Role Assignment

Once TrustAI Marketplace was selected, the team established the two principal Agile roles and agreed that detailed technical ownership would be refined after the first backlog was prepared.

Role	Owner	Kickoff responsibility
Product Owner	Ahmed Al-Mandalawi	Product vision, personas, user stories, initial backlog, acceptance criteria, UML/planning artifacts and functional direction.
Scrum Master	Mulima Chibuye	Sprint cadence, project timeline, project board, blockers, meeting rhythm and team coordination.
Development Team	Ranga Nyamadzawo, Adrian Muchatibaya, Samar El Ghandour and Abdallah Mohmoud	Technical workstreams to be allocated during backlog refinement and Sprint 1 planning, with collaboration across the system.

7. Initial Development Approach

The team agreed that the implementation should support parallel contribution rather than forcing everyone to work sequentially on the same component. The following initial work areas were discussed:

- Authentication and user management.
- Listing input and processing.
- AI-assisted listing analysis.
- Pricing and risk-scoring logic.
- Frontend user interface.
- DevOps, CI/CD, deployment, testing and documentation.

GitHub was identified as the shared engineering environment for code collaboration and pull requests. Ahmed Al-Mandalawi took the follow-up responsibility for preparing or sharing the repository. The team also clarified that the important access requirement was for Quantic to be able to review the repository and for the application to be publicly accessible for demonstration; the repository itself did not necessarily have to be public if the required grader access was provided.

8. Agile Process and Project Management

The team agreed that a formal project-management board was needed to organize the product backlog, sprint work, owners and status. Jira was discussed as one option and GitHub Projects was also considered. The final board choice had not yet been made at kickoff.

The team agreed to use an Agile delivery model with at least three major sprints. Weekly meetings were considered appropriate, while WhatsApp would support day-to-day coordination between meetings. Meeting times could remain flexible provided changes were communicated and the cadence of progress was maintained.

The importance of maintaining meeting minutes and sprint evidence was also recognized at this stage so that significant decisions, progress and engineering work would remain traceable during the final Capstone documentation and presentation.

9. Timeline and Delivery Strategy

The team discussed the September submission deadline and agreed that working all the way to the final date would create unnecessary risk. The preferred strategy was to complete the core product early enough to leave a meaningful buffer for integration, testing, bug fixing, documentation, polish and presentation preparation.

Buffer Strategy

The team discussed aiming to be substantially complete roughly two weeks before the official deadline so that the remaining time could be used for quality assurance, documentation, demo preparation and resolution of late defects.

The initial direction was to use the first sprint to establish the project foundation, with later sprints focused on building, integrating, testing and polishing the application. Mulima Chibuye, as Scrum Master, would help maintain the cadence and keep the schedule visible to the team.

10. Agreed Action Items

Owner	Role	Action	Target
Ahmed Al-Mandalawi	Product Owner	Prepare the product vision, personas, first user stories, UML/planning diagrams, story points where possible, acceptance criteria and the initial backlog. Prepare or share the GitHub repository.	Before next meeting
Mulima Chibuye	Scrum Master	Create or configure the project-management board, establish the sprint cadence and prepare the initial project timeline.	Before next meeting

Owner	Role	Action	Target
Entire team	Development Team	Review the proposed user stories and backlog, prepare for backlog refinement, and be ready to discuss workstream ownership and Sprint 1 scope.	Before next meeting
Entire team	Ongoing practice	Continue day-to-day coordination through WhatsApp, maintain regular meetings, document key decisions and retain meeting/sprint records as project evidence.	Ongoing

11. Decisions Made

- TrustAI Marketplace was selected as the team's MSSE Capstone project.
- Ahmed Al-Mandalawi was assigned as Product Owner.
- Mulima Chibuye was assigned as Scrum Master.
- The project would use Agile delivery with at least three major sprints.
- A formal project-management board would be used; Jira and GitHub Projects were still under consideration at kickoff.
- The team would collaborate through GitHub and pull requests.
- The application would be deployed to a publicly accessible environment for testing, progress check-ins and the final presentation.
- The next meeting would be held the following Wednesday at the same time for backlog refinement and Sprint 1 planning.

12. Risks and Open Questions

Area	Kickoff concern / open question
Scope control	Avoid expanding the MVP before the core user journey is working.
Pricing and data	Define how pricing, risk scoring and scam indicators can be evaluated without overstating what the system knows.
AI reliability	Keep recommendations explainable and frame them as decision support rather than guaranteed truth.
Integration	Integrate services early rather than developing isolated pieces until the end.
Documentation	Maintain meeting records, sprint evidence, architecture decisions and testing evidence throughout the project.
Deployment	Confirm the hosting platform, public access path and subdomain during the early implementation period.

13. Next Meeting

The next meeting was scheduled for Wednesday, July 8, 2026, at the same time. Its purpose was to review the Product Owner's planning material and move into backlog refinement and Sprint 1 planning.

Planned agenda	Planned agenda (continued)
Review the product vision and personas.	Assign technical responsibilities and workstream ownership.
Review and refine the first user stories.	Finalize Sprint 1 scope.
Estimate story points where practical.	Confirm the project-management tooling, repository structure and deployment direction.
Prioritize the initial backlog.	

Closing position. The meeting closed with agreement that the team needed to move quickly, maintain regular communication and avoid leaving integration, documentation or deployment work until the end of the Capstone period. TrustAI Marketplace had been selected, the Product Owner and Scrum Master roles were established, and the immediate priority was to convert the chosen concept into a refined backlog and a practical Sprint 1 plan.